



DELHI PUBLIC SCHOOL NEWTOWN
SESSION 2025-2026
HALF YEARLY EXAMINATION

CLASS: VIII
SUBJECT: ENGLISH PAPER I (SET A)

FULL MARKS: 80
TIME: 2 HOURS

Answers to this Paper must be written on the paper provided separately.

You will not be allowed to write during the first 10 minutes.

This time is to be spent in reading the question paper.

The time given at the head of this Paper is the time allowed for writing the answers.

Attempt all five questions.

The intended marks for questions or parts of questions are given in brackets [].

This paper consists of seven printed pages.

Question 1

Write a composition (300-350 words) on any one of the following:

[20]

- i) *‘One should opt for more online shopping than buying from local markets.’* Express your views either for or against this statement.
- ii) Write an original short story that begins with the words: *‘One summer night, as I was on the terrace, I suddenly saw two strangers under the street light in front of....’*
- iii) Suppose you had shifted to a small town away from the chaos of the city. One day, you got to know about an old library located there. One afternoon, you happened to visit the library. Describe the spot where the library was located, the library building from outside and what you saw inside of the library. Share your feelings while being in that atmosphere.
- iv) Narrate an experience where you struggled to achieve something important to you- be it academics, sports, or a hobby. Share what went wrong, how you felt and what helped you push through or make peace with the outcome.

- v) Study the picture given below. Write a story or a description or an account of what it suggests to you. Your composition may be about the subject of the picture or you may take suggestions from it; however, there must be a clear connection between the picture and your composition.



Question 2

Select any one of the following:

[10]

- i) You recently attended a workshop on Artificial Intelligence organized by your school. Write a letter to your friend telling him/her about this workshop. Mention the venue, duration, the presentation style of the resource person, the atmosphere at the venue and how you felt. Also write how you wish to implement your acquired knowledge from the workshop in your studies.
- ii) Of late this summer, you have been observing that the street lights in your locality are kept switched on till late hours in the morning. Write a letter to the Municipal Councillor of your locality highlighting this matter and mentioning two distinct reasons for your concern.

Question 3

- i) Your school is organizing a trip to the Indian Museum in Kolkata to celebrate the 49th International Museum Day this year. Write a notice for the school notice board informing students from classes VI to VIII about the trip and inviting them to be a part of this trip. [5]
- ii) This year, the world is celebrating the 49th International Museum Day. As a part of the celebration your school is organizing a drawing and painting exhibition on Indian historical sites and events. Write an email to the Director of the Indian Museum in Kolkata inviting him to be the Chief Guest of the programme. [5]

Question 4

Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions that follow:

Madhuram and Sampat lived in the same village. While Sampat owned the largest jewellery shop in the village, Madhuram was a poor farmer but he never begged for help to anyone. Both had large families with sons, daughters-in-law and grandchildren.

One fine day, Madhuram, worried of not being able to feed his family, decided pragmatically to leave the village and move to the city being sanguine of getting a job there. He along with his family left the village for the city. At night, they stopped under a large tree which was the hideout of a thief. There was a stream running nearby where they could freshen up themselves.

Madhuram told his sons to clear the area below the tree, he told his wife to fetch water and he asked his daughters-in-law to make up the fire and started cutting wood from the tree himself. They didn't know that in the branches of the tree, there was a thief hiding. He watched as Madhuram's family got going. He also noticed that they had nothing to cook.

Madhuram's wife also thought the same and asked her husband, "Everything is ready but what shall we eat?"

Madhuram raised his hands to heaven and said, "Don't worry. He is watching all of this from above. He will help us."

The thief got worried as he had seen that the family, though large, worked well together. He feared of being caught. Taking advantage of the fact that they did not know he was hiding in the branches, he decided to make a quick escape. He climbed down safely when they were not looking and ran for his life. But, he left behind the bundle of stolen jewels and money which dropped into Madhuram's lap. Madhuram opened it and in elation felt blessed when he saw the contents. He told his family to gather all their belongings as they would return to the village.

There was great stir when they told everyone how they got rich. Sampat thought wily that the tree was miraculous and this was a nice and quick way to earn some money. He ordered his family to pack some clothes and they covertly set off for that tree.

They also stopped under the same tree. Feeling tired, Sampat started commanding everyone to do things as Madhura had done. But no one in his family was willing to obey his orders. Being a rich family, they were used to having servants all around. So, the one who went to the river to fetch water enjoyed a nice bath. The one who went to get wood for fire went off to sleep after roving for some time.

Not having any food, Sampat's wife said, "Everything is ready but what shall we eat?"

Sampat raised his hands and said, "Don't worry. God will help us."

As soon as he finished saying, the thief, who, that day too, was hiding among the branches, jumped down from the tree with a knife in hand. Seeing him, everyone ran away to save their lives.

The thief stole everything they had and Sampat and his family had to return to the village empty handed, having lost all their valuables that they had taken with them.

i) For each word given below choose the correct meaning (as used in the passage) from the options provided: [2]

1. *sanguine*

- a) hopeful
- b) uncertain
- c) feeling an inner urge
- d) informed by someone

2. *elation*

- a) amazement
- b) supreme satisfaction
- c) gratitude
- d) joy

ii) Which word in the passage means the opposite of '*by letting everyone know*'? [1]

- a) hideout
- b) wily
- c) covertly
- d) pragmatically

iii) Answer the following questions briefly in your words:

- a) Quote the sentence from the passage which tells that there was unity in Madhura's family. [1]

- b) Why did Madhuras decide to move to the city? [2]
 - c) What did Madhuras do on finding valuables in the bundle which fell into his lap? [2]
 - d) How can you say that Sampat was dominating by nature? [2]
 - e) Mention with justification two character traits of Madhuras. [2]
- iv) In not more than 50 words, state what Sampat and his family did on reaching the tree till a turn of events occurred. [8]

Question 5

- i) Fill in each of the numbered blanks with the correct form of the verb from the options given in brackets. Do not copy the passage but write in correct serial order the word or phrase appropriate to the blank space. *Example: (0) is* [4]

There ____ (0) ____ a mango tree outside my house. Khushwant ____ (1) ____ (*plant*) it a week before his wife ____ (2) ____ (*give*) birth to their daughter. They ____ (3) ____ (*name*) the tree and their daughter Hasi and Khushi at that time. Even today, after long ten years Khushi ____ (4) ____ (*found*) her best friend in Hasi. The couple ____ (5) ____ (*take*) care of the two with all their heart and soul. Newly I ____ (6) ____ (*appoint*) as the private tutor of little Khushi. I ____ (7) ____ (*visit*) her tomorrow. She ____ (8) ____ (*wait*) eagerly to introduce me to her dear friend Hasi.

- ii) Fill in the blanks with appropriate prepositions: [4]

- a) I saw her wiping the table _____ a moist cloth.
- b) She was engaged _____ a rich handsome businessman.
- c) I was at a loss _____ words after hearing the news.
- d) Now that you are hired, you are _____ the company's payroll.
- e) This hair dye is made _____ hibiscus extract.
- f) Tell me the essence _____ the board meeting yesterday.
- g) The angry villagers set the cruel landlord's house _____ fire.
- h) He was conferred _____ the Nobel Peace Prize.

- iii) Join the following sentences to make one complete sentence without using *and*, *but* or *so*. Choose the correct option. [4]

1. Priyam did not watch the match. Preeti did not watch the match.
- a) Neither Priyam nor Preeti did watched the match.
 - b) Neither did Priyam watch the match nor Preeti watched the match.
 - c) Priyam as well as Preeti did not watch the match.
 - d) Neither Priyam nor Preeti watched the match.

2. The hunter had fired the shot. The pigeons flew away.
 - a) When the hunter had fired the shot, the pigeons flew away.
 - b) No sooner had the hunter fired the shot than the pigeons flew away.
 - c) Hardly did the hunter fire the shot when the pigeons flew away.
 - d) When the hunter had fired the shot, the pigeons flew away immediately.
3. The thief was planning his next heist. The police entered his house.
 - a) The thief was planning his next heist when the police entered the house.
 - b) The police entered the thief's house while he was planning his next heist.
 - c) While the thief was planning his next heist, the police entered his house.
 - d) As the thief was planning his next heist, the police entered the house.
4. The road was congested. We reached the spot late.
 - a) As the road was congested, we reached the spot late.
 - b) The road was congested therefore we reached the spot late.
 - c) Since the road was congested we reached the spot late.
 - d) Both a) and b)

iv) Rewrite the following sentences according to the instructions given after each. Make other changes but do not change the meaning of each sentence. Choose the correct options. [8]

1. I shall speak with him. (*Position the adverbs 'never' and 'impolitely' correctly in the sentence*)
 - a) I shall never speak impolitely with him.
 - b) I never shall speak impolitely with him.
 - c) I shall never speak with him impolitely.
 - d) Both a) and c)
2. She blew out the candles on her birthday cake. (*Change the voice*)
 - a) Let the candles on her birthday cake be blown out by her.
 - b) The candles on her birthday cake were blown out by her.
 - c) The candles on her birthday cake were blowed out by her.
 - d) The candles had been blown out on her birthday cake by her.
3. Sunny said, "What a thrilling match this is!" (*Change the mode of narration*)
 - a) Sunny exclaimed in excitement that this match was thrilling.
 - b) Sunny exclaimed in excitement that the match was very thrilling.
 - c) Sunny exclaimed in excitement that that match was very thrilling.
 - d) Sunny exclaimed in excitement that this was indeed a thrilling match.

4. My nose woke me up as the sweet scent from the sewer entered my room. (*Identify the Figure/s of Speech in the sentence*)
- a) Only Personification
 - b) Only Alliteration and Euphemism
 - c) Only Personification and Alliteration
 - d) Alliteration, Euphemism and Personification
5. The sergeant said to me, “Show your license right now.” (*Change the mode of narration*)
- a) The sergeant instructed me to show my license right then.
 - b) The sergeant told to me to show my license right then.
 - c) The sergeant instructed me to show my license right now.
 - d) Both a) and b)
6. Select the sentence from below where adverbs have been positioned correctly.
- a) Confidently he is smart enough to handle the situation.
 - b) He is enough smart to handle the situation confidently.
 - c) He is smart enough to handle the situation confidently.
 - d) He is confidently smart to enough handle the situation.
7. Your business proposal interests me. (*Change the voice*)
- a) I am interested by your business proposal.
 - b) I am interested with your business proposal.
 - c) I am interested at your business proposal.
 - d) I am interested in your business proposal.
8. Though initially undecided, we finally took the right route to reach the resort. (*Identify the Figure/s of Speech in the sentence*)
- a) Only Alliteration
 - b) Only Pun and Alliteration
 - c) Only Irony and Alliteration
 - d) Alliteration, Irony and Pun